discomfort, like a cast around a broken ankle, a cast that's going to come off soon. Start with just $100 a month, if you can, or less, if that's too much. What's the worst thing that can happen? You'll have $300 at the end of the experiment. That's the obvious outcome, but the result you want to achieve is the mild discomfort you'll feel in month four, when you don't set aside your $100. As I said earlier, people who are good with money don't feel well when they're overextended. Instead of avoiding that kind of discomfort, cultivate it.

Money Mistake: You Have No Emergency Savings

THE FIX: SET ASIDE SOMETHING—ANYTHING

We can't talk about saving and investing and other financial vehicles until you get a handle on your output. I want you to be able to walk past those shoes, that boat, that car—even that cup of coffee—and be able to say no. Because you'll have created a comfortable financial threshold you can live just beneath. This is, after all, a health issue—your and your family's health.

Let's put a number on it. This gap between what you have and what you can afford should feel tangible. Going back to your 90-Day Number, and assuming you're now taking in less than you're putting out, the first thing to ask yourself is: *What is fixed and what is flexible about these numbers?* Let's assume your input is fixed, that the amount you take in isn't going to fluctuate in those ninety days. Using common metrics and basic math, let's also apply a few basic tenets of financial planning. Say your input is $4,000 after taxes. I'm rounding it up and down a little in each category to keep the numbers simple. This is also assuming there is a little debt, but nothing unmanageable. Again, we're looking at an ideal financial situation.

OUTPUT	PERCENTAGE OF INCOME	TOTALS IN $ SPENT
Housing	25%	1,000
Saving	5%	200
Investing	5%	200